

Mrs. Rasmussen | ESL 1 Class Syllabus

English as a Second Language | Grades 4-8 | Mary, Star of the Sea School

School Year 2026-2027

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Welcome Parents and Guardians!

I am Mrs. Rasmussen, your child's English as a Second Language teacher. I am a graduate of the University of Hawaii with a Bachelor's in Secondary Education / Social Studies and a minor in Psychology. I have additional coursework in Montessori and Early Childhood Development and am certified to teach preschool through grade 12.

I have spent years substituting in public schools, an orthopedic unit, a deaf and blind school, and special education. I also spent 10 years at Star of the Sea Early Learning Center in preschool and kindergarten. I have tutored students in various subjects since 1978 and have been an ESL teacher at Mary, Star of the Sea since 2006.

I am here to facilitate your child's learning of English as well as support their functioning in the regular classroom. In ESL 1, we work on speaking and oral reading; we write weekly on a variety of topics; and we learn vocabulary words and their usage.

Communication among teachers, students, and parents is essential in learning English. I am grateful for your support and the opportunity to work with your child.

Sincerely,

Mrs. Rasmussen | drasmussen@starofthesea.org

Our Mission

To provide a Christ-centered education that reflects academic excellence and stewardship, and to provide a learning environment where students can foster confidence and social skills and become lifelong learners.

Essential Question: How do you navigate to become a shining star?

Academics

- **Imagine Learning** - Online reading program used throughout the year.
- **Explode the Code** - Phonics and reinforcement.
- **Spelling Skills** - Vocabulary development at each student's level.
- **Language Arts** - Parts of speech and sentence structure.
- **Reading Skills** - Facts, Sequence, Context, Main Idea, Conclusion, and Inference.
- **Writing Skills** - Personal narratives, informative writing, descriptive writing, opinion and comparative writing, stories, and short reports.

English as a Second Language - Scope

- **I. Communication:** Oral and written communication; understanding directions; listening and following directions.
- **II. Vocabulary & Grammar Usage:** Parts of speech; writing in complete sentences; mechanics.
- **III. Reading:** Decoding words; punctuation; intonation; fluency.
- **IV. Comprehension:** Understanding directions and questions; responding in complete sentences; context clues; main idea; noting details; cause and effect; predicting outcomes; inferences; drawing conclusions.
- **V. Writing:** Sentences, questions, and answers; short answers, paragraphs, essays; different forms of writing.

Homework & Support at Home

- **Homework** - Assigned daily, about 20 minutes of independent work. Due when the next class is in session.
- Computers and other tools such as dictionaries are allowed.
- I encourage the use of English in the home daily.
- **Reading aloud** - 20 minutes each day helps students speak English clearly and write in complete sentences.
- Students who need assistance completing assignments may finish their work during lunch recess in my room.

"Let's work together for a successful year!"

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith